

Requirement Analysis & Planning

Overview

The **Requirement Analysis & Planning** phase serves as the foundation of the **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System**. The objective of this phase is to understand the business challenges associated with frequent SLA violations and design a proactive governance solution using native ServiceNow capabilities.

Traditional SLA monitoring processes often notify users only after an SLA has already been breached, resulting in delayed responses, poor accountability, inconsistent documentation, and limited visibility for management. To address these challenges, this project proposes a zero-code, administrator-driven solution that proactively detects SLA risk, notifies users before a breach occurs, and guides them through corrective actions using the ServiceNow Virtual Agent.

During this phase, business requirements were collected from stakeholders, project objectives were defined, system boundaries were established, and key functional and non-functional requirements were documented. The planning process also identified stakeholders, user roles, governance policies, and reporting requirements necessary for successful implementation.

Business Problem

Organizations depend on Service Level Agreements (SLAs) to ensure timely incident resolution and maintain service quality. However, many organizations experience recurring SLA breaches due to:

- Lack of proactive SLA monitoring
- Delayed notifications to incident assignees
- Manual follow-up processes
- Missing or incomplete breach justification
- Limited accountability among assigned users
- Poor visibility into SLA performance
- Difficulty maintaining audit-ready records

These issues reduce operational efficiency, impact customer satisfaction, and make compliance reporting more challenging.

Project Objectives

The project aims to achieve the following objectives:

1. Proactive SLA Awareness

Provide early notification when an incident approaches its SLA threshold. Users receive automated alerts and Virtual Agent guidance before the SLA is breached, enabling timely corrective action.

2. Reduce SLA Violations

Encourage assignees to take preventive action by identifying incidents at risk and requiring them to document breach reasons and corrective measures before SLA expiration.

3. Improve SLA Governance

Establish standardized governance by enforcing mandatory SLA breach reason and justification fields through UI Policies and maintaining consistent documentation for management review.

4. Enhance User Experience

Replace manual reminders and email follow-ups with an interactive Virtual Agent that provides conversational guidance, improves user engagement, and simplifies SLA compliance.

5. Strengthen Accountability

Require incident assignees to explicitly acknowledge SLA risk and submit breach-related information. This ensures ownership and accountability throughout the incident lifecycle.

6. Operational Transparency

Provide managers and stakeholders with real-time dashboards and reports that display SLA trends, breach reasons, acknowledgement status, and assignee performance, enabling informed decision-making.

Project Scope

The scope of the project includes:

In Scope

- Automatic attachment of Incident Resolution SLAs
- Continuous SLA percentage monitoring

- Detection of SLA-at-risk incidents
- Flow Designer automation for email notifications
- Virtual Agent conversation for SLA awareness
- UI Policy enforcement for mandatory governance fields
- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- SLA acknowledgement tracking
- SLA breach reason and justification management
- Real-time reports and dashboards
- Audit-ready activity history

Out of Scope

- Custom scripting beyond administrator-level configuration
- Integration with external ITSM platforms
- Predictive AI or machine learning for SLA forecasting
- Custom mobile application development
- Changes to core ServiceNow SLA engine

Stakeholder Analysis

Stakeholder	Responsibilities
IT Agents	Resolve assigned incidents, acknowledge SLA risk, and provide breach justification.
Service Desk Managers	Monitor SLA compliance, review reports, and oversee governance activities.
ServiceNow Administrators	Configure SLAs, Flow Designer, UI Policies, ACLs, Virtual Agent, and dashboards.
Business Owners	Define SLA policies, governance requirements, and compliance expectations.
Management	Review SLA trends, accountability metrics, and operational performance.

Functional Requirements

The system shall:

- Automatically attach the appropriate SLA to new incidents.
 - Continuously monitor SLA progress.
 - Identify incidents approaching SLA breach.
 - Trigger automated email notifications using Flow Designer.
 - Provide SLA awareness through the Virtual Agent.
 - Capture SLA acknowledgement from users.
 - Enforce mandatory SLA Breach Reason and SLA Breach Justification fields.
 - Restrict SLA field updates based on user roles.
 - Record SLA-related activities for auditing.
 - Generate reports and dashboards for management.
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Non-Functional Requirements

The solution should:

- Be implemented using native ServiceNow features without custom code.
 - Support real-time SLA monitoring.
 - Ensure secure access using Role-Based Access Control.
 - Maintain accurate and reliable audit logs.
 - Deliver a user-friendly conversational experience through the Virtual Agent.
 - Provide scalable reporting suitable for enterprise environments.
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Assumptions

- Incident Resolution SLAs are already configured.
- Users have valid ServiceNow accounts.
- Email notifications are enabled.
- The Virtual Agent plugin is available and configured.
- Flow Designer is active in the ServiceNow instance.

- Required user roles and permissions are assigned.
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Constraints

- Implementation is limited to administrator-level, zero-code configuration.
 - The project focuses only on Incident Management.
 - SLA monitoring depends on existing SLA definitions.
 - The solution is designed for native ServiceNow capabilities without external integrations.
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Expected Deliverables

- Requirements specification document
 - Stakeholder analysis
 - Functional and non-functional requirements
 - Scope definition
 - Governance objectives
 - High-level solution plan
 - Implementation roadmap
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Benefits

- Early awareness of potential SLA breaches
 - Reduction in SLA violations
 - Improved accountability among assignees
 - Consistent documentation of SLA breach reasons
 - Enhanced governance and compliance
 - Improved operational transparency
 - Better user experience through conversational guidance
 - Audit-ready records for management and compliance reviews
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Conclusion

The **Requirement Analysis & Planning** phase establishes a clear understanding of business needs and defines the roadmap for implementing a proactive SLA governance solution in ServiceNow. By identifying stakeholder expectations, documenting requirements, and defining project scope, this phase ensures that the solution addresses operational challenges effectively. The planned system leverages native ServiceNow capabilities to improve SLA compliance, strengthen accountability, enhance user experience through the Virtual Agent, and provide management with real-time visibility into SLA performance while maintaining audit readiness.